development environment (IDE) and editor options available for you to build applications.

NOTE In this book I use Visual Studio for most of the examples, but you'll be able to follow along using any of the tools I discuss here. The book assumes that you've successfully installed .NET 7 and an editor on your computer.

A.1 Installing the .NET SDK

The most important thing you need for .NET Core and .NET 7 development is the .NET SDK. In this section I describe how to install the .NET SDK and how to check which version you have installed.

To start programming with .NET, you need to install the .NET SDK (also known as the `dotnet` CLI). This contains the base libraries, tooling, and compiler you need to create .NET applications.

You can download the .NET SDK at https://dotnet.microsoft.com/download. This page contains links to download the latest version of .NET for your operating system. If you're using Windows or macOS, the page contains installer download links; if you're using Linux, the page has instructions for installing .NET using your distribution's package manager, as a Snap package, or as a manual download.

WARNING Make sure that you download the .NET SDK, not the .NET Runtime. The .NET runtime is used to execute .NET applications, but it can't be used to build them. The .NET SDK includes a copy of the runtime, so it can run your applications, but it can also build, test, and publish them. Also make sure to choose the right architecture—x64 or arm64—depending on your processor's architecture.